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FULL COMMITTEE BUSINESS MEETING

MARK-UP OF A REPORT

for the

COMMITTEE ON OVERSIGHT AND GOVERNMENT REFORM

U.S. HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES

ONE HUNDRED NINETEENTH CONGRESS

SECOND SESSION

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C O N T E N T S

BILL CONSIDERED

H.Res. 1543, Recommending That the House of Representatives Find Leon David Black In Contempt of Congress for Refusal to Comply With Subpoenas Duly Issued By The Committee on Oversight and Government Reform
Bill Discussed 1

FULL COMMITTEE BUSINESS MEETING MARK–UP OF A REPORT

TUESDAY, SEPTEMBER 15, 2026

U.S. HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES
COMMITTEE ON OVERSIGHT AND GOVERNMENT REFORM
Washington, D.C.

The Committee met, pursuant to notice, at 5:12 p.m., in room 2154, Rayburn House Office Building, Hon. James Comer [Chairman of the Committee] presiding.

Present: Representatives Comer, Jordan, Turner, Grothman, Cloud, Palmer, Sessions, Biggs, Mace, Fallon, Perry, Timmons, Boebert, Luna, Burlison, Crane, Jack, McGuire, Gill, McCormick, Garcia, Norton, Lynch, Krishnamoorthi, Khanna, Mfume, Brown, Stansbury, Frost, Casar, Crockett, Randall, Subramanyam, Ansari, Bell, Simon, Min, Walkinshaw, Menefee, Pressley, and Tlaib.

Chairman COMER. The Committee will please come to order. A quorum is present.

Without objection, the Chair is authorized to declare a recess at any time.

Pursuant to Committee Rule 5(b) and House Rule XI, Clause 2, the Chair may postpone further proceedings today on the question of approving any measure or matter or adopting an amendment on which a recorded vote or the yeas and nays are ordered.

H.RES. 1543, RECOMMENDING THAT THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES FIND LEON DAVID BLACK IN CONTEMPT OF CONGRESS FOR REFUSAL TO COMPLY WITH SUBPOENAS DULY ISSUED BY THE COMMITTEE ON OVERSIGHT AND GOVERNMENT REFORM

Now pursuant to notice, I call up a Report containing a Resolution recommending that the House of Representatives find Leon D. Black in contempt of Congress for refusal to comply with duly issued subpoenas issued by the Committee.

The clerk will report the Report, which has been distributed in advance.

The Clerk. A Report containing a House Resolution recommending that the House of Representatives find Leon D. Black in contempt of Congress for refusal to comply with duly issued subpoenas issued by the Committee on Oversight and Government Reform.

Chairman COMER. I ask unanimous consent that the Report be considered as read and open for amendment at any point.

Without objection, so ordered.

The Chair recognizes himself to offer the amendment in the nature of a substitute.

The clerk will please report the amendment.

The Clerk. An amendment in the nature of a substitute offered to the Contempt Report as offered by Mr. Comer of Kentucky.

Chairman COMER. Without objection, the amendment is considered as read, and the substitute will be considered as original text for the purposes of further amendment.

I now recognize myself for 5 minutes for a statement on the report.

Today, the House of Representatives Committee on Oversight and Government Reform meets to advance a resolution recommending that the House find Leon D. Black in contempt of Congress for refusing to comply with duly issued subpoenas, our investigation examining how Federal Government for decades failed survivors of Jeffrey Epstein and Ghislaine Maxwell's crimes, and how Mr. Epstein sought to curry favor and exercise influence to avoid scrutiny.

I subpoenaed Leon Black for testimony and documents critical to our investigation, but he has refused to comply. Leon Black is legally required to appear for a deposition before the Oversight Committee and required to turn over all nondisclosure agreements to which he was a party. The Committee also asked for all Non-Disclosure Agreement (NDA)s and confidentiality agreements that Epstein and Maxwell were involved or referenced in. He defied Congress and refused to do either. Instead, Mr. Black is hiding behind litigation to delay having to provide answers to the American people. No one is above the law. Mr. Black will be treated the same as anyone else in this investigation, and his actions have consequences.

A little over two months ago, Mr. Black appeared before the Committee for a transcribed interview, but only an hour into the interview he began refusing to answer questions. So, we issued two subpoenas to him, one for a deposition and one to produce his confidentiality agreements. Mr. Black did not appear for a scheduled deposition on September 3, 2026, and only produced one NDA to the Committee, despite his counsel indicating there were many more. Subpoenas are not suggestions. They carry the force of law and require full compliance.

Mr. Black's testimony is crucial to our investigation because he maintained a close personal relationship with Epstein for years during the time when Epstein was engaged in sex trafficking. Mr. Black and Epstein also had a significant financial relationship. He funded Epstein's lavish lifestyle for years, enabling Epstein to continue his horrific crimes. His testimony about Epstein, Maxwell, and their crimes is invaluable. The Committee wants to ensure that NDAs or other confidentiality agreements cannot be used to cover up criminal activities. We made it clear to Mr. Black and his attorneys that if he did not comply, then the Committee would initiate contempt proceedings. We have no choice but to hold him in contempt. I encourage my colleagues to support this measure.

I now yield to Ranking Member Garcia for his opening statement.

Mr. GARCIA. Thank you, Chairman Comer, and we are really here today on a, really, bipartisan basis because Leon Black is refusing to cooperate with our investigation as an Oversight Committee on the investigation, of course, of Jeffrey Epstein.

Now, we believe that Leon Black is at the heart of the Epstein network. This is a private equity billionaire worth roughly $13 billion. We need to know why Jeffrey Epstein got over $180 million from Mr. Black. We know this money enabled Epstein's activities for years, and we need to know how and if it led to the abuse of women and girls. We need to know about Leon Black and Jeffrey Epstein's financial dealings. We need to know about the role of the Big Banks, and we need to, for us as a Committee, focus on how we, in the future, combat money laundering and sex trafficking. This investigation is important and can lead to so much for the protection of women and girls across this country.

We also need to know about the involvement of other powerful and wealthy men and how law enforcement failed to protect survivors. We need to know about Mr. Black's knowledge of Epstein's inner circle and activities. We need to know why he used nondisclosure agreements to silence women connected to Jeffrey Epstein, but Leon Black is refusing to provide this information to Congress. Now, this Committee has tried to work with him to get answers, but he has had no interest in cooperating, and I do want to thank Chairman Comer for his efforts. We support and did support his efforts on these subpoenas, and they are absolutely the right thing to do to get to the truth.

We should not allow Leon Black to defy congressional subpoenas. Our investigation is about fighting for the survivors of Epstein's abuse, and we are going to develop reforms and legal changes to ensure the system that allowed Jeffrey Epstein and his billionaire friends to continue their activities for years comes to an end.

Now, Leon Black walked out of an interview with our Committee. He refused to turn over documents. He refused to show up and testify for the deposition. That is two congressional subpoenas now that he has defied. It is unacceptable to this Committee, and, unfortunately, billionaires like Leon Black believe that they are above the law. Some of them certainly do. He believes that he is above this Committee's oversight authority. He believes he is too powerful for Congress or the American people to touch, but we are going to stand up and remind Leon Black and the American people that subpoenas are not suggestions.

Finally, I want to note that Leon Black certainly is not the only witness who has refused to answer our questions. For example, of course, Alan Dershowitz has repeatedly said he would appear before this Committee to talk about Jeffrey Epstein, but when given the opportunity, he has also backed out twice. Now, Dershowitz may have been the President's lawyer, but he is also not above the law in answering this Committee's questions. Alan Dershowitz should come forward and tell the American people and our Committee what he knows, and certainly today, this Committee should be focused on Leon Black and moving this motion that is in front of us forward to the full House.

I thank Chairman Comer for his bipartisanship today, and I yield back.

Chairman COMER. The gentleman yields back. Does any other Member wish to be heard?

[No response.]

Chairman COMER. Seeing none, the question is now on the amendment in the nature of a substitute to the Report recommending the House of Representatives refer Leon D. Black for contempt of Congress.

All those in favor, signify by saying aye.

[Chorus of ayes.]

Chairman COMER. All those opposed, signify by saying no.

[No response.]

Chairman COMER. In the opinion of the Chair, the ayes have it, and the amendment in the nature of a substitute to the Report is agreed to.

The question is now on favorably reporting that the House of Representatives Refer Leon Black for Contempt of Congress.

The clerk will now call the roll on the Report.

The Clerk. Mr. Jordan?

[No response.]

The Clerk. Mr. Turner?

Mr. TURNER. Aye.

The Clerk. Mr. Turner votes aye.

Mr. Gosar?

[No response.]

The Clerk. Ms. Foxx?

[No response.]

The Clerk. Mr. Grothman?

Mr. GROTHMAN. Aye.

The Clerk. Mr. Grothman votes aye.

Mr. Cloud?

[No response.]

The Clerk. Mr. Palmer?

[No response.]

The Clerk. Mr. Higgins?

[No response.]

The Clerk. Mr. Sessions?

Mr. SESSIONS. Aye.

The Clerk. Mr. Sessions votes aye.

Mr. Biggs?

Mr. BIGGS. Aye.

The Clerk. Mr. Biggs votes aye.

Ms. Mace?

Ms. MACE. Aye.

The Clerk. Ms. Mace votes aye.

Mr. Fallon?

[No response.]

The Clerk. Mr. Donalds?

[No response.]

The Clerk. Mr. Perry?

[No response.]

The Clerk. Mr. Timmons?

Mr. TIMMONS. Aye.

The Clerk. Mr. Timmons votes aye.
Mr. Burchett?
[No response.]
The Clerk. Ms. Boebert?
Ms. BOEBERT. Aye.
The Clerk. Ms. Boebert votes aye.
Mrs. Luna?
[No response.]
The Clerk. Mr. Langworthy?
[No response.]
The Clerk. Mr. Burlison?
Mr. BURLISON. Aye.
The Clerk. Mr. Burlison votes aye.
Mr. Crane?
Mr. CRANE. Aye.
The Clerk. Mr. Crane votes aye.
Mr. Jack?
Mr. JACK. Aye.
The Clerk. Mr. Jack votes aye.
Mr. McGuire?
Mr. MCGUIRE. Aye.
The Clerk. Mr. McGuire votes aye.
Mr. Gill?
Mr. GILL. Aye.
The Clerk. Mr. Gill votes aye.
Mr. McCormick?
Mr. MCCORMICK. Aye.
The Clerk. Mr. McCormick votes aye.
Mr. Garcia?
Mr. GARCIA. Aye.
The Clerk. Mr. Garcia votes aye.
Ms. Norton?
Ms. NORTON. Aye.
The Clerk. Ms. Norton votes aye.
Mr. Lynch?
Mr. LYNCH. Aye.
The Clerk. Mr. Lynch votes aye.
Mr. Krishnamoorthi?
Mr. KRISHNAMOORTHI. Aye.
The Clerk. Mr. Krishnamoorthi votes aye.
Mr. Khanna?
Mr. KHANNA. Aye.
The Clerk. Mr. Khanna votes aye.
Mr. Mfume?
Mr. MFUME. Aye.
The Clerk. Mr. Mfume votes aye.
Ms. Brown?
Ms. BROWN. Aye.
The Clerk. Ms. Brown votes aye.
Ms. Stansbury?
Ms. STANSBURY. Aye.
The Clerk. Ms. Stansbury votes aye.
Mr. Frost?
Mr. FROST. Aye.

The Clerk. Mr. Frost votes aye.
Mr. Casar?
Mr. CASAR. Aye.
The Clerk. Mr. Casar votes aye.
Ms. Crockett?
Ms. CROCKETT. Aye.
The Clerk. Ms. Crockett votes aye.
Ms. Randall?
Ms. RANDALL. Aye.
The Clerk. Ms. Randall votes aye.
Mr. Subramanyam?
Mr. SUBRAMANYAM. Aye.
The Clerk. Mr. Subramanyam votes aye.
Ms. Ansari?
Ms. ANSARI. Aye.
The Clerk. Ms. Ansari votes aye.
Mr. Bell?
Mr. BELL. Aye.
The Clerk. Mr. Bell votes aye.
Ms. Simon?
Ms. SIMON. Aye.
The Clerk. Ms. Simon votes aye.
Mr. Min?
Mr. MIN. Aye.
The Clerk. Mr. Min votes aye.
Mr. Walkinshaw?
Mr. WALKINSHAW. Aye.
The Clerk. Mr. Walkinshaw votes aye.
Mr. Menefee?
Mr. MENEFEE. Aye.
The Clerk. Mr. Menefee votes aye.
Ms. Pressley?
Ms. PRESSLEY. Aye.
The Clerk. Ms. Pressley votes aye.
Ms. Tlaib?
Ms. TLAIB. Aye.
The Clerk. Ms. Tlaib votes aye.
Mr. Chairman?
Chairman COMER. I vote aye.
How has Mrs. Luna been recorded?
The Clerk. Mr. Chairman votes aye. Mrs. Luna is not recorded.
Mrs. LUNA. I like to record my vote as aye.
The Clerk. Mrs. Luna votes aye.
Chairman COMER. And, Madam Clerk, we have one in the hallway walking in right now.
Have all Members been recorded who wish to be recorded?
[No response.]
Mrs. LUNA. Jordan is on his way.
Chairman COMER. Okay. We have one more.
How has Mr. Cloud been recorded?
The Clerk. Mr. Cloud is not recorded.
Mr. CLOUD. Aye.
The Clerk. Mr. Cloud votes aye.
[Pause.]

Chairman COMER. How has Mr. Jordan been recorded?
The Clerk. Mr. Jordan is not yet recorded.
Mr. JORDAN. Yes. Yes. Sorry.
The Clerk. Mr. Jordan votes yes.
[Pause.]
Chairman COMER. How has Mr. Fallon been recorded?
The Clerk. Mr. Fallon is not yet recorded.
Mr. FALLON. Aye.
The Clerk. Mr. Fallon votes aye.
Chairman COMER. How has Mr. Perry been recorded?
The Clerk. Mr. Perry has not yet been recorded.
Mr. PERRY. Aye.
The Clerk. Mr. Perry votes aye.
[Pause.]
Chairman COMER. How has Mr. Palmer been recorded?
The Clerk. Mr. Palmer has not yet been recorded.
Mr. PALMER. Aye.
The Clerk. Mr. Palmer votes aye.
Chairman COMER. Now, have all Members been recorded who wish to be recorded?
[No response.]
Chairman COMER. Does any Member wish to change their vote?
[No response.]
Chairman COMER. The clerk will now report the vote total.
The Clerk. Mr. Chairman, on this vote, the ayes are 41. The nays are zero.
Chairman COMER. Pursuant to this vote, let me say the ayes have it, and let the record note it was a unanimous vote.
Pursuant to this vote, the Committee hereby favorably reports and adopts this Report recommending that the House of Representatives find Leon D. Black in contempt of Congress for refusal to comply with subpoenas duly issued by this Committee. We will move the Report to the full House.
Without objection, the motion to reconsider is laid on the table.
Pursuant to House Rule XI, Clause 2, Committee Members shall have the right to file with the Clerk of the Committee supplemental, additional, Minority, and dissenting views within two days.
Without objection, so ordered.
Additionally, the staff is authorized to make necessary technical and conforming changes to the Report ordered reported today, subject to the approval of the Minority.
Without objection, so ordered.
If there is no further business before the Committee, without objection, the Committee stands adjourned.
[Whereupon, at 5:32 p.m., the Committee was adjourned.]